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November 24, 2025

Hiring Committee
Insight Economics
8910 University Center Ln
San Diego, CA 92122

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in a consulting Economist/Analyst position at Insight Economics. I am a Ph.D. candidate in the Department of Economics at Johns Hopkins University (advisors: Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis), and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My primary specializations are macroeconomic modeling, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on the ability of macroeconomic models to generate empirically realistic distributions of wealth and income over the life cycle. A key driver of that work is modeling heterogeneity in the rate of return on assets, and understanding how return dispersion contributes to portfolio accumulation across households. These themes relate directly to Insight's consulting and expert-witness practice, which emphasizes rigorous economic analysis, clarity in communication, and credibility in litigation, valuation, and business-strategy matters. :contentReference[oaicite:1]index=1

In my job-market paper, I calibrate a life-cycle heterogeneous-agent model to match wealth moments from the Survey of Consumer Finances by allowing households to differ in their portfolio returns. The model helps explain observed wealth concentration and return dispersion. In a related research project using the Health and Retirement Study, I examine how trust influences both income growth and asset returns—finding a hump-shaped relationship for returns and characterizing the distribution of the persistent component of returns to net worth. These experiences have equipped me to: (i) frame research strategies and design modeling approaches; (ii) execute econometric and simulation analysis with large micro-data sets; and (iii) translate quantitative findings into clear, rigorous written deliverables for both academic and practitioner audiences.

I am especially excited about the opportunity to join Insight Economics because of its reputation for high-stakes consulting work, which includes expert testimony, valuation of IP and business assets, and economic modelling for litigation and arbitration. My quantitative toolkit (Python, Stata), experience dealing with heterogeneous behavior and simulation models, and ability to communicate complex analysis clearly make me well-suited to support casework on damages estimation, business valuation, market analysis, and competitive harm investigations. I am also drawn to Insight's collaborative culture and emphasis on professional growth in an intellectually challenging consulting environment.

I believe I would be a strong fit at Insight Economics because:

1. My experience in simulation-based modelling and structural estimation aligns closely with

Insight's analytical frameworks in litigation and valuation.

2. My work on heterogeneity in economic outcomes helps inform questions of market behaviour, business valuation, and economic harm, which are key to Insight's consulting engagements.
3. I bring strong communication and teamwork skills essential for producing high-quality quantitative reports and interacting with clients, attorneys, and expert economists.

I would welcome the opportunity to contribute my analytical rigor, empirical modelling experience, and passion for applied economics to Insight Economics. Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards